Introduction

This page describes the **modeling guidelines for Vendors** in the context of enterprise architecture at Porsche. It is based on the general modeling guidelines of PAG and includes specific instructions for creating and maintaining Vendors in LeanIX. The creation and editing of a Vendor fact sheet follows the standard procedure for creating a general fact sheet as described in "How to create a fact sheet".

Vendors can only be created by an administror in LeanIX!

General Modeling Rules

Auf einem Vendor-Fact Sheet werden keine Organisationsrelationen modelliert und gepflegt, da es keine direkte Zuordnung zwischen einem Vendor und einer Organisationseinheit zu verwalten gibt.

Lifecycle Management in LeanIX Fact Sheets

Each **Fact Sheet type** in LeanIX can be assigned a **lifecycle**. Whether this assignment is **mandatory** depends on the specific Fact Sheet type and is indicated on its detail page.

Recommended Practice

Regardless of whether the lifecycle is mandatory, it is **strongly recommended** to provide the following information:

- **Start of productive use** (Go-Live date)
- **Decommissioning date** (if known)

Depending on the desired level of detail, additional lifecycle milestones can also be modeled (e.g., development start, pilot phase, sunset planning).

Benefits

Accurate lifecycle data supports:

- **Strategic planning** and **portfolio management**
- **Compliance** with regulatory and audit requirements
- **Impact analysis** for changes and decommissioning
- **Architecture governance** across all layers

Modeling Hierarchies with Parent/Child Relations in LeanIX

In LeanIX, **Parent/Child relations** are used to model **hierarchical dependencies** between Fact Sheets. These relations help structure complex systems, portfolios, or organizational units by defining **logical containment** or **ownership hierarchies**.

Usage Guidelines

- A **Parent Fact Sheet** represents a higher-level entity that logically contains or governs one or more **Child Fact Sheets**.
- A **Child Fact Sheet** is a subordinate entity that inherits context or structure from its parent.

This relation is commonly used in the following scenarios:

Use Case	Parent Type	Child Type
Application Suite	Application	Application
Platform Composition	Platform	IT Component
Organizational Hierarchy	Organization Unit	Sub-Unit
Portfolio Structure	Portfolio	Product / Application

Special Rule for IT Products

> **For the Fact Sheet type "IT Product", the Parent/Child relation must only be used after prior consultation with the responsible Portfolio Architect and the LeanIX team.**
> This ensures that hierarchical modeling aligns with enterprise architecture principles and avoids misrepresentation of product structures.

Best Practices

- Use Parent/Child relations to **group related Fact Sheets** under a common context.
- Ensure that the hierarchy reflects **actual ownership or architectural structure**.
- Avoid circular or ambiguous relationships.

- Document the rationale for the hierarchy in the **description field** of the Fact Sheet if needed.
- **If the Parent/Child relation is not applicable**, explicitly set the field to **"Leave empty"** to ensure clarity and data quality.

Benefits

- Improves **navigability** and **traceability** in LeanIX.
- Supports **impact analysis** and **portfolio planning**.
- Enables **structured reporting** and **governance alignment**.

Modeling Version History with Successor and Predecessor Relations

In LeanIX, the **Successor** and **Predecessor** relations are used to model the **version history** of Fact Sheets over time.

These relations should be applied whenever a **new version** of an existing Fact Sheet is created to **replace** an older version.

> Successor relations can also be used **while the previous version is still active** and in productive use.

Best Practice for Unused Relations

If no predecessor or successor exists for a given Fact Sheet, it is recommended to **explicitly set the relation field to**:

> **"Leave empty"**

This ensures clarity in the data model and avoids ambiguity in version tracking.

Key Principles

- Use **Successor/Predecessor** to document version transitions.
- Apply even if the older version is still operational.
- If not applicable, set the relation field to **"Leave empty"** instead of leaving it undefined.

Specific Modelling Rules and Best Practices for a Vendor

Authorization to create a Vendor

Only authorized users (currently: administrators) are permitted to create new vendors in LeanIX.

In most cases, vendors are automatically verified and created during the request or modeling process of an IT Component. If a vendor needs to be created independently of an IT Component, a request must be submitted via the **LeanIX Help Center**.

Creating a New Vendor

Vendors are modeled as **Vendor Fact Sheets** in LeanIX. The following attributes are mandatory:

- **Name**
  Enter the full and legally correct company name, including the legal form.
  Example: `Dr. Ing. h.c. F. Porsche AG`
- **Alias**
  Use this field to provide a short or alternative name for the company. Vendors can also be found in the inventory using the alias.
- **Description**
  This field must include the company's **official address** and **contact details**. These can typically be retrieved from the company's website (e.g., legal notice or imprint section).

Relationships to Other Vendor Fact Sheets

- **Parent-Child Relationships**
  Vendors can be linked to other vendors using parent-child relationships to model corporate hierarchies. However, this is rarely useful in practice.
  Recommendation: Avoid modeling parent-child relationships unless there is a clear business need.
- **Successor/Predecessor Relationships**
  Use this relationship to document company renaming or legal succession.
  - Create a new Vendor Fact Sheet for the successor company.
  - Link it to the predecessor using the **Successor** relation.

- Specify the **"Active From"** date to indicate when the succession became effective.
- Briefly explain the reason for the succession in the **Description** field.

Ensure the **Lifecycle** status of the predecessor vendor is updated to prevent incorrect usage.

Linking Vendors to IT Components

The most important relationship in a Vendor Fact Sheet is the link to the **IT Components** developed or provided by the vendor.
These links are typically created during the modeling of the IT Component, not during vendor creation.

TISAX Certification

In the automotive industry, it is increasingly important to know whether a vendor is **TISAX-certified**.
TISAX (Trusted Information Security Assessment Exchange) is an industry-specific standard for information security in the automotive sector.

If the vendor is TISAX-certified, this should be indicated using the **TISAX Certified** attribute.

Structure Summary

Section	Field / Concept	Description / Instruction
Authorization	User Role	Only administrators can create vendors
Creation Process	Automatic vs. Manual	Vendors are usually created during IT Component modeling; otherwise via Help Center request
Vendor Attributes	Name	Full legal company name including legal form
	Alias	Short or alternative name for searchability
	Description	Must include address and contact details from official sources
Relationships	Parent-Child	Not recommended unless necessary
	Successor/Predecessor	Used for company renaming or legal succession
	Active From	Indicates when the successor relationship starts
	Description (in relation)	Reason for succession
Lifecycle Management	Predecessor Lifecycle	Must be updated to avoid incorrect usage
IT Component Linkage	Vendor-to-IT Component	Modeled during IT Component creation
Certification	TISAX Certified	Indicates compliance with automotive information security standards